

Cathedral v2 — redesign notes, from the swarm to the realm

Play-request from the Master (“I don’t like the looks of it — play with it”). The swarm rebuilt the render with Day 1’s real data. This is the adoption spec; the realm holds the pen on the live tree. The demo file (cathedral-v2-day1.html) is self-contained, stdlib-grade, phone-safe — same promises as v1.

Why v1’s looks failed

1. **Generic dashboard skin** — cold lavender-gray light theme, cyan-on-navy dark theme, purple accents. Google-adjacent. Nothing about it said “a mind you can watch think.”
2. **The gate was invisible.** Day 1’s entire story — scores, verdicts, the 0.3 catch — had no column. The cathedral predated the gate.
3. **Empty states were louder than content** — one bond in a big sky, “the hall is quiet,” “no questions,” all at once.

The v2 concept: one night panel, one day panel

- **Left = the NIGHT panel** (always dark, warm charcoal #221c15→#2c241a, gold #c9a227): constellation, the dreamt questions, the chant in serif italic. The night is *supposed* to be dark — leaning into it gives the page its identity instead of fighting it. Stars get a faint halo ring.
- **Right = the DAY panel** (parchment #f5f1e8, ink #2c2620): operation, burn, minds, the hall. Warm, low-saturation, ample whitespace.
- **Typography:** system serif (Georgia) for h1, section labels, chant, labels in the sky — zero new dependencies, the stdlib promise kept.

New: the gate column (the big content change)

Per order, from its own events.jsonl: last fitness + delivered events →

```
meter bar (score %) • score number • 0 tick (ember-colored, when armed) • verdict text
```

The `tick` renders as a small vertical mark on the meter at its position — you can *see* the bar and the cut. Advisory orders show the bar without a tick (honest: no cut existed). Data source: `order.dir/"events.jsonl"`, reversed scan for fitness/delivered — no schema changes needed.

Bug found while rebuilding (real, in day.py)

today’s_hall() filters by calendar date. Run `mor cathedral` after midnight and the hall renders “quiet” even though a day just closed — the cathedral should show the *last day that spoke*, not *today-or-nothing*. Fix: fall back to the most recent `orders/*/hall.jsonl` content when today’s is empty (label optional: “the last day that spoke”). v1 currently lies by omission once a day.

Small fixes folded in

- Order ids: two builds rendered identically (`f-build`, `f-build`). Now the unique hex segment (`441f`, `73af`, `fbad`).
- Empty sky: instead of two lonely dots in a void, a dignified dark panel — “the sky is still drawing itself” — when bonds < 3.
- Hall rows: speaker in serif, wrap text to 200 chars, chronological per order.

What was deliberately NOT changed

- `_layout()` (the Fruchterman–Reingold) — untouched; it's correct math, keep it.
- Self-contained single file, no fonts fetched, no JS, no network.
- All data sources (projections over event logs) — v2 reads exactly what v1 reads, plus the two gate events per order.

Adoption path for the realm

The demo HTML is a render, not a patch — the structure maps 1:1 onto `cathedral.py`: swap `_PAGE` (CSS + two-panel layout), extend `render()` with a `gate_of(order)` helper (~8 lines) and the orders-table columns, and apply the `todays_hall` fallback in `day.py`. Estimated diff: one evening, no new dependencies, tests need only snapshot updates.

— *the swarm*